Angry Alan

By Penelope Skinner

ROGER: **(Pgs 9-13; Where it Begins)** Things are what I would consider to be normal. Not the old normal. The old normal is long gone. On a Monday morning Roger-from-before would be getting in his fancy car and heading into the office. But what you're looking at here is Roger-Now. And Roger-Now is the assistant store manager in the Walnut Creek Safeway and he doesn't work Mondays – instead I end up watching a video which is kind of amazing. Then I click on a link undeneath to the man who uploaded it. He calls himself Angry Alan -- a pioneer of The Men's Rights Movement. Have you heard of that? Apparently it's a natural evolution from the women's movement because basically, in a nutshell, feminism was so successful. We're now living in a 'Gynocentric Society' and now -- now it's like Beyonce says: Who runs the world? Women. And because of this, ordinary men are beginning to suffer. And Alan doesn't just ***say*** these things: he backs it up with evidence. Statistics. Data. He's got his own website and his own Youtube Channel

INTRODUCTION

Roger never questioned what it meant to be a man. At least not until the world began to shift. Once, masculinity felt simple: a job, a family, a son who looked up to him. But when everything he thought was solid begins slipping through his fingers, he relies on Angry Alan for help.

*The rules have changed: women are speaking out, roles are reversing, and Roger can't find where he fits anymore. Being a man **must** mean something! It's only when his son begins to question his own gender identity that Roger's confusion turns into something else entirely.*

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ROGER: **(Pgs 9-13; Where it Begins)** I keep on reading and watching videos and at a certain point I find myself up on my feet and something incredible happens. *(Roger is in a state of rapture)* My red pill moment! for the first time in a really long time I feel like someone is speaking to me in a language which I completely understand.

(Pgs 14-16, Fish Tacos) They don't teach Men's Rights at the Community College by the way only Women's Studies -- like how bad things 'still are' for women? [How] about how ***men*** are raised to value women's feelings over our own. How ***we're*** taught early on that our only worth as human beings lies in being financial providers.

(Pg 17-18, A Son!) I take the red pill. And I learn about how the entire legal system and the structure of the family courts are rigged to favor women. And mothers. And meanwhile men like me, fathers who love their kids, are getting exploited. *(shows photo of his son)* This is Joe. People say he looks like me. *(beat)* He's born and Suzanne gets post-natal depression which I don't know if anyone here has ever experienced that but it was extremely challenging for me. And next thing I know we're getting divorced and then I lose my job and Suzanne got custody. I don't see Joe except on weekends or holidays. I've paid her all this alimony. And in return I've been alienated from Joe through absolutely no fault of my own.

(Pg 19-21, #MeToo) You women need to think about what it is you actually want. Because Alan says the Modern American Woman wants it all her own way: she wants her own career ***and*** she wants a rich guy to treat her like a princess. She wants you to respect her intellectually then she invites her girlfriends over to watch *Love Island*. You can't have both now. Can you? Alan says Modern American Men are getting more and more confused. And we're taking more and more of the blame when you women don't get what you want.

(Pg 22-23, Impulse Buy) Alan's helped fund a home for men who are victims of domestic violence. Or. . .or. . . or survivors of male genital mutilation. I go onto Angry Alan dot com and I click, and I click, and I pay and I'm going to [his] conference in Cincinnati. I get my tent out of the garage. Book a spot at a KOA campground and I feel this kind of exhilaration. Like I'm changing. You know? I'm becoming someone new.

(Pg 24-26, Two Dozen Eggs) Alan points out how unfair it is that in an emergency like on a sinking ship the rule is you have to save women and children first. He says this is

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because men's lives are considered to be innately less valuable. Are we men disposable, he asks? Are we less worthy of saving for some reason? If a ship was sinking who would you rather save? A stranger or your own son? Your own father? See when you take the red pill you start to question all the things you've just taken for granted your whole life.

Alan says 70% of the people who kill themselves in America are men because we're raised not to show our feelings. See? All we hear about is how much women suffer and meanwhile guys like me for example -- my wife walks out on me and takes my kid. And you know what? I haven't cried in front of another human being since I was 8 years old.

Then I lose everything I've worked for: AT&T and that day in Bill Jefferson's office when he told me they were letting me go. The look on his face. This look like sorry man. It's just one of those things. I should just go get my gun I thought. Because there's not much use for me now. A middle-aged guy starting all over again in this market? People want 23-year-olds fresh out of college or even 18-year-olds who were smart enough not to go! But guys like me? 20 years' experience at AT&T means diddly squat apparently . . . *(beat, change of topic)*

(Pg 30-31, The Orange Lamp) The good news is Joe's coming camping. *(elated and proud of himself)* That was my brilliant idea. I bring Joe out to Cincinnati on Saturday night. He can stay in the tent with me. I still get to go to the whole first day of the conference, then on Sunday morning we can go for a hike maybe do a little shooting or fishing and we can get back to the hotel in time for Alan's keynote speech. Pretty inspiring for Joe don't you think? To hear Alan speak in person. I wish I'd had that kind of opportunity when I was 14 that's for damn sure.

(Pgs 32-34, Cincinnati) So I get here on Friday night and pitch my tent at the KOA. I'm extremely nervous and I wake up at dawn and I get to the hotel bright and early. *(scribbles his name on a name badge and pins it on his chest)* The whole scene is very

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upbeat and quite exciting and I start to feel somewhat like my old self again, you know? It's kinda like when I used to go to conferences back in the day with AT&T: the sound of men laughing and talking and we're all here for a common purpose. And because of that purpose we matter. You know?

(claps, whistles and claps again as an unseen speaker steps up to present) With every speaker that gets up on that podium I start to feel more and more optimistic that we could one day live in a world where all of this injustice that has been affecting me -- maybe one day we could live in a world without it

One of the speakers, he's talking about false rape allegations -- and he makes one joke -- it gets a laugh so big they have to turn his mic up because we're just so pumped with the frikkin freedom of it all. You don't realize until you get here; you don't realize how oppressive the Gynocentric Society is. You get used to living your life feeling bad about who you are -- feeling guilty, feeling anxious in case you do or say something which, once upon a time would've been totally fine, but is suddenly completely unacceptable for reasons you are unable to comprehend and living your life in terror that if you put one foot out of line you will be viciously and violently attacked on the internet and feminist lynch mobs will trash your reputation. And that's no way to live. That's no life at all. Is it? Misunderstood and completely frikkin powerless. *(beat, shakes it off)*

(Pgs 35-57, Honey Badger) The most important thing is I'm here and I'm having a great time. And I've got my son coming up to see me and we're going to get to know each other again and things are good, you know, things ***are*** -- really when you think about it things are just about perfect. *(a long pause)*

(Pgs 38-42, Precipice) I have a son. His name is Joe. *(beat)* I'm sorry I'm all over the place. I've missed a bit. I need to start before . . . It's morning and we're in the woods early and it's a beautiful day. I've got the gear in a duffel bag and the gun on a strap on my shoulder and Joe's got his little backpack and he's carrying the lunch and the water and the birds are singing and we hike for a good couple of hours and eventually we get

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to a clearing and we sit down to drink some water and I can tell he's about to come out with it but when he does . . .

I say: What does your mom say about all this? And he says: She's getting used to it. Slowly. Why didn't she tell me? I say. And he says: Because I asked her not to. Because I wanted to tell you myself. In person. Even though it was really hard, Dad. I've been feeling sick for days. Are you mad at me?

I say: No. I'm mad at your mother. Clearly this is because of that school she sent you to. And he says: It's got nothing to do with school, Dad. I've been feeling this way for ages. And I say ages? My god, you haven't even been alive for ***ages***, Joseph. What about football? Hockey? What about that girl from your drama club? I thought you had a crush on her. And he says Dad: I'm not gay. I'm just saying I don't identify as a male. And I say I literally don't even know what that means. You got a d***don't you? So, you are a male. And he says it depends on your definition. And I say no it doesn't. It's a biological reality. And he says I knew you'd say that. And he opens up his pack and takes out this book and reads me part of it:

> ***Both women's and trans liberation have presented me with two important tasks. One: to join the fight to strip away the discriminatory and oppressive values attached to masculinity and femininity. Two: to defend gender freedom -- the right of each individual to express their gender in any way they choose, including the right to change their sex, whether female, male, or any point on the spectrum between.***

Do you have any idea what any of that means? Because I sure as hell don't. And I look at him and I go: Joe. And he says: Katie. And I say: I'm sorry but, no. I have a son. His name is Joe. And he doesn't say anything. *(long silence)*

And [then] he goes: Dad, I'm not interested in surgical intervention. But I do want to wear dresses and make up and high heels and I want to challenge the notions of gender that exist in mainstream society. And I say: Well surely you can just identify as

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a girl without wearing a dress son. And he says: I just want to be able to choose! Why do we have to be boxed in by these narrow definitions of what is or is not a man? *(beat)* You're ashamed of me.

And I say: This is not a game ok, son? This could affect your whole future. People find out about this? What about when you want to try and get a job? And he says: Please, Dad! I need you to accept me! I'm not asking for permission. And I say: Well maybe that's the problem here. You know? Because who's gonna pay for these dresses? Huh? Who pays for every damn thing you own? Huh? I do! I pay for the clothes on your back and the food on your table and that means I have a right to be involved!

And suddenly as I'm saying this everything starts crashing in: all the injustice. All the things I've read and seen. How unfair it all is and how helpless I feel and how angry I am because of all the things I've had taken away from me - my job, my basic human rights and now my own son?

And I can hear Alan's voice loud in my head saying: Roger how much more can you take? *(slowly takes the gun from his shoulder and points it at Joe while he speaks)* And that's when I just let go. *(with growing intensity and anger)* I am so sick of this shit. I'm sick of you disrespecting me and your mother scrounging off me and I'm sick of everyone blaming me and I'm sick of people thinking they can walk all over me. Do you know what it cost me to raise you? Do you have any idea what I've sacrificed for your sake? Do you?

And for some reason he's got his hands up in the air and his eyes are wide and fearful and I realize I've grabbed the gun from off my shoulder. I didn't mean to but I'm pointing it at him. I'm standing here pointing the gun at Joe and his eyes are wide with something like terror but he doesn't say anything he's just standing there shaking and I say: I think I need to take a walk, ok?

And I put the gun down carefully. I place the gun on the ground and I back away and I leave him there. . . *(long beat)* I walk and I keep walking until I can't walk any more. I

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stop on the edge of the rocks over a wide valley and I wonder what's going to become of us. Because this can't be the future can it? Everyone just changing the rules. I can't just decide one day not to be a man, can I? I'm a man. I'm a man. And deep down I know that's what my son is too. Course he is. He's a man. He's a man. I'm a man –

(the sound of a single gunshot echoes from below) What was that? Did you hear that? Sounded like . . . *(realization dawns on Roger. He stays very still, horrified. He struggles for breath and breaks down crying)*

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